2026

(CBCS)

(2nd Semester)

HISTORY

SECOND PAPER

(History of India up to the Post-Maurya Period)

Full Marks : 75

Time : 3 hours

The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions.

(SECTION : A—OBJECTIVE)

(*Marks* : 10)

Tick (✓) the correct answer in the brackets provided : 1×10=10

1. The oldest surviving texts in India are

(a) the Puranas ( )

(b) the Dharmashastras ( )

(c) the Vedas ( )

(d) the Tipitakas/Tripitakas ( )

2. Which of the following was/were the cause/causes for the decline of the Harappan Civilization?

(a) Dravidian invasion ( )

(b) Religious differences among the priests ( )

(c) Natural calamities such as deforestation, floods, earthquakes and famines ( )

(d) All of the above ( )

3. Which one among the following is most widely accepted as the homeland of Indo-Aryans?

(a) India ( )

(b) Arctic region ( )

(c) Eastern Europe (North of the Black Sea) ( )

(d) Central Europe ( )

4. Bhagadugha was the

(a) tax collector ( )

(b) commander of the army ( )

(c) chief priest ( )

(d) charioteer ( )

5. What is meant by Janapada?

(a) A region consisting of urban and rural settlements ( )

(b) A region consisting of only tribal settlements ( )

(c) A region consisting of big towns and cities ( )

(d) A region consisting of only Dvijas ( )

6. The heterodox sects were known as

(a) Varna ( )

(b) Sapinda ( )

(c) Shramana ( )

(d) Pratiloma ( )

7. The Saptanga Rajya list consists of

(a) 3 elements of State ( )

(b) 5 elements of State ( )

(c) 7 elements of State ( )

(d) 9 elements of State ( )

8. Which of the following statements on the Mauryan art and architecture is incorrect?

(a) The pillars of Ashoka bear a striking resemblance to those of Darius. ( )

(b) The polish of the pillars is unique. ( )

(c) The wording on pillars, particularly referring to the king, is the same as that of Darius. ( )

(d) The testimony of wood-cutter art being transformed into that of stone-cutter. ( )

9. Who were the first to begin feudalism in India?

(a) The Mauryas ( )

(b) The Kushanas ( )

(c) The Shungas ( )

(d) The Satavahanas ( )

10. The Sangam literature was written in the language of

(a) Sanskrit ( )

(b) Tamil ( )

(c) Telugu ( )

(d) Kannada ( )

(SECTION : B—SHORT ANSWERS)

(*Marks* : 15)

Answer the following questions : 3×5=15

UNIT—I

1. What do you know about the Puranas?

Or

2. What is Ethnography?

UNIT—II

3. What are the Rig-Vedic Sabha and Samiti?

Or

4. What is Varna?

UNIT—III

5. What are the four Ashramas?

Or

6. What are the two kinds of State that are mentioned in the list of Mahajanapadas?

UNIT—IV

7. What are the Greek-Roman texts used for reconstructing the Mauryan period?

Or

8. What do you mean by Ashoka's Dhamma?

UNIT—V

9. Who was Gautamiputra Satakarni?

Or

10. What is the importance of the site of Arikamedu for the Indo-Roman trade?

(SECTION : C—DESCRIPTIVE)

(*Marks* : 50)

Answer the following questions : 10×5=50

UNIT—I

1. Give an account of the archaeological sources for the reconstruction of early Indian history.

Or

2. Discuss the decline and continuity of the Harappan culture.

UNIT—II

3. Discuss the debate on the origin of Aryans.

Or

4. Examine the chief features of the later Vedic period.

UNIT—III

5. What is the circumstance that led to the rise of heterodox sects?

Or

6. Give an account of the Macedonian invasion and its impacts.

UNIT—IV

7. What factors underlay the emergence of the Mauryan Empire?

Or

8. What was the extent of the State's control over economic activities in the Mauryan Empire?

UNIT—V

9. What was the significance of the Indo-Roman trade?

Or

10. Discuss the society in early historical South India as reflected by the Sangam Literature.

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